



Chocolatier

*Build a chocolate empire from
market stalls to royal
assortments.*

RULEBOOK · VERSION 2.2.1

3–4 players · About 90–120 minutes

Overview

You run a chocolate atelier. Buy ingredients, hire staff, and upgrade your factories so each recipe pays you every round. After three stages, the player with the highest net worth wins.

What you are doing each round: shape the shared market, buy what you need, play optional Schemes, assign staff and recipes to your factories, then collect income.

Contents of this booklet

1. Setup and game structure
2. Each round, step by step
3. Factories and recipes
4. Research and Reputation
5. Buying from the pool
6. Schemes
7. Masteries
8. End-of-stage relief
9. Final scoring
10. Reference tables

What you start with

- **\$20 million** in cash.
- One **Basic Cocoa** and one **Sugar** in your Supply — enough to make Basic Chocolate.
- **Four factories**, each with three ingredient slots. Larger recipes need extra slots.
- No Research, no Reputation, and no Schemes yet.

Game structure

The game is for **three or four players**. It lasts **three stages**. Each stage has **eight rounds**.

New cards each stage

- Stage 1: Cocoa, Sugar, Milk, Matcha
- Stage 2: the above + Coffee, Almond, Caramel, Premium Cocoa, Premium Sugar, Premium Milk
- Stage 3: the above + Wild Berries, Sea Salt, Royal Honey, Premium Coffee, Premium Almond

Turn order

At the start of every stage, everyone secretly bids cash for turn order. The highest bid goes first. Ties go to the player with more Reputation, then to a re-bid among tied players, then to dice if still tied.

After each round, the first player moves to last place and everyone else moves up one spot.

Hand privacy

Your **hand** (market cards dealt each round) and your **Schemes** are private. Your Supply, factories, tracks, and cash are public.

Each round, step by step

Every round follows these steps in order. End-of-stage relief happens only after the eighth round of Stages 1 and 2.

1 • Market

Each player is dealt nine stage cards face down. Everyone secretly chooses **one** card to contribute. Those cards are shuffled together to form the shared **pool** for this round.

2 • Private Viewing

If you hold the Private Viewing Scheme and have at least **2 Reputation**, you may play it now to jump ahead in the purchase line. If several players play it, resolve in turn order (earlier token first). Playing Private Viewing counts as your one Scheme play for the round.

3 • Purchasing

In turn order, each player takes **one** turn. On your turn you may:

- Take **one card from the pool** — either buy it at its listed price, or discard it to the public Discard pile and take **\$4M / \$8M / \$12M** from the Bank (Stages 1, 2, and 3).
- Buy **Open Market Cocoa or Sugar** for **\$5M / \$10M / \$15M** (by stage).
- If you have **Research Level 3**, buy one **Mastery** from the shared offer for **\$50M** (one Mastery per player; first come, first served in turn order).

The Open Market tray restocks at the start of each stage. Unsold stock carries over.

4 • Schemes

In turn order, each player may optionally:

- Pay **1 Reputation** to draw three Scheme cards and keep one (hand limit three; you cannot draw if fewer than three remain in the deck).
- Play **one Scheme** from hand (Veto Power is the exception — see Schemes section).

When you play a Scheme, every other player gets a chance to cancel it with Veto Power. If it is not cancelled, resolve its effect. The exact Scheme name is never announced — only that someone played one.

5 • Assignment

Build your atelier for this round:

- Place **Researchers** and **Journalists** from Supply onto your Research and Reputation tracks.
- Bank **Extra Ingredient Slot** cards, then attach slots to factories.
- Select ingredients from Supply and assign a **recipe** to an empty factory.
- **Tear down** a factory for free: ingredients return to Supply and you may assign a new recipe the same round.

When you complete a recipe for the first time this game, you earn Reputation (see below). Reputation is awarded only after **every player** has finished Assignment. If several players make the same recipe in the same round, the earlier turn-order token earns the bonus for being first in the game.

6 • Income

Everyone is paid at once:

- Factory income from each running recipe.
- Research track income.
- Reputation track income.

Temporary Scheme effects may change this payment. Final scoring later ignores those temporary boosts.

7 • Rotate first player

The first player token moves to last. Begin the next round.

After the **eighth round** of Stage 1 or Stage 2, resolve **end-of-stage relief** before the next stage begins (see Relief section). There is no relief after Stage 3.

Factories and recipes

- A recipe needs the **exact ingredient types and counts** shown — nothing extra, nothing missing.
- Each recipe lists a **Research level** you must reach before you can assign it (unless Unlicensed Chef removes that gate).
- Any number of players may run the **same recipe** — there is no global limit.
- **Premium** Cocoa, Sugar, or Milk add **\$1M** to that factory's income. Premium Coffee or Almond add **\$2M**.
- A factory using a **hazardous** extra slot loses **\$1M / \$2M / \$3M** in Stages 1, 2, and 3.
- Factories keep paying every round until you tear them down.

Reputation for new recipes

When you assign a recipe (after everyone finishes Assignment):

- 3 ingredients → **1 Reputation**
- 4 ingredients → **2 Reputation**
- 5 ingredients → **3 Reputation**
- 6 ingredients → **6 Reputation**

Plus **1 extra Reputation** if you are the first player in the game to make that recipe (Basic Chocolate never grants this bonus).

Research

Assign Researchers from Supply to your Research track:

- Junior Researcher → **+1** Research point
- Senior Researcher → **+2** Research points
- Master Researcher → **+3** Research points

Research levels

Level	Points needed	Track income per round	Unlocks
1	3	\$1M	Research Level 1 recipes; 25% off Coffee and Almond purchases
2	7	\$3M (stacks with Level 1 → \$4M total)	Level 2 recipes; 25% off Wild Berries and Caramel
3	11	\$6M (stacks → \$10M total at Level 3)	Level 3 recipes; 25% off Royal Honey; buy Masteries

Sea Salt can be bought from the pool with no Research gate, but recipes that use Sea Salt still need Research Level 2 to assign.

Reputation

Assign Journalists from Supply to your Reputation track:

- Junior Journalist → **+2** Reputation
- Senior Journalist → **+3** Reputation
- Master Journalist → **+4** Reputation

Reputation levels

Level	Points needed	Track income per round	Shop unlocks (one-time purchase)
1	4	\$1M	Extra slot \$5M · Junior Researcher \$4M
2	12	\$3M (stacks → \$4M)	Extra slot \$10M · Extra factory \$20M · Senior Researcher \$10M
3	20	\$6M (stacks → \$10M)	Another Senior Researcher \$10M

Reputation is also spent to draw and play Schemes. There is **no free Research** from Reputation.

Shop unlocks stay available even if you later drop below the level, but track income and ingredient discounts fall until you climb back up.

Reputation grants the same 25% family discounts as Research (Coffee/Almond, Wild Berries/Caramel, Royal Honey). Discounts from both tracks **add together**.

Most Reputable

The title goes to the first player with a **unique lead** and at least **4 Reputation**. A tie does not remove the title — the holder keeps it until another player has **strictly more** Reputation (and still at least 4), or the holder drops below 4.

While you hold the title, pool purchases cost less:

- Stage 1 or 2: **\$2M** off the face price
- Stage 3: **\$3M** off

Then Research and Reputation percentage discounts apply to the original face price. The title does **not** discount Open Market Cocoa or Sugar.

Hostile Takeover makes you Most Reputable for this turn and the next two, overriding the usual rules.

Buying from the pool

Face prices are printed on each card. Extra Ingredient Slots cost **\$5M / \$10M / \$15M** depending on which stage they entered the deck.

When buying from the pool, discounts apply in this order:

1. Most Reputable flat discount (if you hold the title).
2. Research 25% off eligible families (round down from original face price).
3. Reputation 25% off the same families (also from original face price).

Price cannot fall below zero.

Schemes

Schemes are optional. Each lists a Reputation cost to play. Other players may cancel with **Veto Power** (which does not count as their Scheme play for the round).

Scheme	Cost	Effect
Artificial Shortage	2 Reputation (equal to the current stage)	Choose any ingredient. Every player loses 1 copy of that ingredient from Supply. Factories are untouched.
Black Market	3 Reputation (stage plus one)	Take one card from the public Discard for free.
Defamation Ops	1 Reputation	Steal 2 Reputation from the Most Reputable player and 1 from every other player. Your factories pay \$0 this turn. Unplayable if the title is vacant or you hold it.
Double Agent	2 Reputation	Choose two other players. Look at their hands and swap one hand card with each of them.
Embargo	1 Reputation	Choose an ingredient other than Cocoa or Sugar. Recipes using it pay \$0 this turn and next turn.
Embezzlement	1 Reputation	Each other player pays you \$3/\$6/\$9M in Stages 1–3. Players who cannot pay in full pay all cash they have.
Forced Swap	2 Reputation (equal to the current stage)	Swap one Supply card with another player. If yours costs more, pay the difference to that player.
Hazardous Warehousing	1 Reputation	Bank an extra factory slot. Any factory using it pays –\$1/–\$2/–\$3M in Stages 1–3 (current stage).
Hostile Takeover	1 Reputation	You are Most Reputable for this turn and the next 2, overriding the usual title rules.

Labour Exploitation	1 Reputation	Your factory income is doubled this turn, then \$0 next turn.
Money Laundering	1 Reputation	Gain \$15/\$25/\$35M from the Bank in Stages 1–3.
Press Leak	2 Reputation	Choose exactly 2 other players. Look at their Schemes. For each who has 2 or more Schemes, you may discard one of theirs to the Scheme discard.
Price Gouging	1 Reputation	Choose an ingredient other than Cocoa or Sugar. Recipes using it pay half their printed income (rounded down) this turn and the next 2.
Private Viewing	2 Reputation	Play only during the Private Viewing window. You cut the purchasing queue. Multiple viewers resolve in current turn order. Counts as your Scheme play for the turn.
Secret Project	1 Reputation	Gain +2 Research Points. Your factories pay \$0 this turn.
Synthetic Ingredient	2 Reputation (equal to the current stage)	Choose any ingredient an opponent has in Supply or a factory. Gain a copy of it. The copy cannot be changed later.
Unethical Research	1 Reputation	Gain +1 Research Point.
Unlicensed Chef	1 Reputation	Choose a recipe. You may ignore its Research requirement for the rest of the game.
Veto Power	1 Reputation	Cancel a Scheme as it is played. Does not count as your Scheme play. The cancelled Scheme costs nothing.

Play costs marked “stage” or “stage plus one” use the current stage number as Reputation (Stage 2 → 2 Rep, etc.). Black Market costs stage plus one.

Masteries

At game start, reveal one unique Mastery per player from the deck. Any player with Research Level 3 may buy one Mastery from the shared offer during the Purchasing phase for **\$50M**, in turn order. Each player may hold only one Mastery.

Mastery	End-game bonus
Chocolatier	Score +5 for every recipe you developed this game.
Exotics Master	Score +120 if you have a factory producing a Research L3 recipe at the end of the game.
Heritage Line	Score 6× the production value of your factories making recipes that need Research L1 or below.
Masterchef	Score +15 for every unique ingredient in your factories at the end of the game.
Experimentalist	Score +120 if you have the most Research Points outright at the end of the game.
Brand Ambassador	Score +120 if you have the most Reputation outright at the end of the game.
Tycoon	Score 1 point per \$M of factory income on the last turn, plus +50 if that factory income is highest.

End-of-stage relief

After Stages 1 and 2, freeze standings using:

- Cash on hand
- Five million dollars per Research point
- Four million dollars per Reputation point
- Three times your clean factory production (ignore temporary Scheme effects)
- Mastery points

Tied players share the **worse** rank. Players ranked third or lower (i.e. not in the top two) may take **one relief package** or skip:

After Stage	Research package	Reputation package	Cash package	Discard ingredient	Score penalty if taken
1	+1 Research point	+2 Reputation	\$10M	One from public Discard	–\$25M at final scoring
2	+2 Research points	+3 Reputation	\$20M	One from public Discard	–\$50M at final scoring

Last place chooses first. If several players tie for last, they roll dice — lowest roll chooses first among the tied players.

Final scoring

After Stage 3, round 8, add everything:

- Cash on hand
- **\$5M** per Research point
- **\$4M** per Reputation point
- **Three times** your last clean factory production (temporary Scheme effects stripped)
- Mastery scores
- **\$25M** split among players tied for most Research points (round down)
- **\$25M** split among players tied for most Reputation points (round down)
- Minus any relief penalties you took (−\$25M or −\$50M per package)

The highest total wins. Ties share victory.

First-game tips

1. Make **Basic Chocolate** on your first Assignment — it starts your income immediately.
2. Bid modestly in Stage 1. Cash spent on turn order is cash you cannot spend on cards.
3. Buy Researchers early. Research Level 1 unlocks stronger recipes and future discounts.
4. Discard useless pool cards for cash rather than gifting them to the next player.
5. Skip Schemes until you have Reputation to spare — they are never required to win.

Reference • Recipes (Stage 1)

Recipe	Ingredients	Income	Research
Basic Chocolate	Cocoa + Sugar	\$1M	none
Dark Chocolate	Cocoa + Cocoa + Sugar	\$2M	none
Milk Chocolate	Cocoa + Milk + Sugar	\$2M	none
Matcha Chocolate	Cocoa + Matcha + Sugar	\$4M	none
White Chocolate	Cocoa + Milk + Sugar + Sugar	\$4M	none

Reference • Recipes (Stage 2)

Recipe	Ingredients	Income	Research
Almond Chocolate	Cocoa + Almond + Sugar	\$3M	none
Coffee Chocolate	Cocoa + Coffee + Sugar	\$4M	none
Caramel Chocolate	Cocoa + Caramel + Sugar	\$6M	none
Extra Dark Chocolate	Cocoa + Cocoa + Cocoa + Sugar	\$5M	Research Level 1
Cream Milk Chocolate	Cocoa + Milk + Milk + Sugar	\$5M	Research Level 1
Milky Almond Chocolate	Cocoa + Milk + Almond + Sugar	\$6M	Research Level 1
Mocha Chocolate	Cocoa + Milk + Coffee + Sugar	\$7M	Research Level 1
Coffee with Almond Chocolate	Cocoa + Coffee + Almond + Sugar	\$9M	Research Level 1
Nutty Mocha Chocolate	Cocoa + Milk + Almond + Coffee + Sugar	\$20M	Research Level 2

Reference • Recipes (Stage 3)

Recipe	Ingredients	Income	Research
Wild Berries Chocolate	Cocoa + Wild Berries + Sugar	\$8M	Research Level 1
Royal Chocolate	Cocoa + Royal Honey + Sugar	\$10M	Research Level 1
Sea Salt Chocolate	Cocoa + Sea Salt + Sugar	\$12M	Research Level 2
Nutty Wild Berries Chocolate	Cocoa + Almond + Wild Berries + Sugar	\$12M	Research Level 1
Coffee Caramel Chocolate	Cocoa + Caramel + Coffee + Sugar	\$12M	Research Level 1
Royal Milk Chocolate	Cocoa + Milk + Royal Honey + Sugar	\$15M	Research Level 1
Salty Nut Chocolate	Cocoa + Sea Salt + Almond + Sugar	\$18M	Research Level 2
Salty Caramel Chocolate	Cocoa + Sea Salt + Caramel + Sugar	\$18M	Research Level 2
Caramelized Wild Berries Chocolate	Cocoa + Wild Berries + Caramel + Sugar	\$20M	Research Level 2
Royal Wild Berries Chocolate	Cocoa + Wild Berries + Royal Honey + Sugar	\$25M	Research Level 2
Royal Caramel Chocolate	Cocoa + Caramel + Royal Honey + Sugar	\$25M	Research Level 2
Royal Mocha Chocolate	Cocoa + Milk + Coffee + Royal Honey + Sugar	\$35M	Research Level 3
Exotics Assorted Mix	Cocoa + Caramel + Wild Berries + Sea Salt + Sugar	\$40M	Research Level 3

Royal Assorted Mix

Cocoa + Coffee + Almond + Wild
Berries + Caramel + Royal Honey

\$60M

Research
Level 3

Reference • Card costs

“Stages” shows when copies enter the deck (n = number of players).

Card	Face cost	Deck stages	Notes
Basic Cocoa	\$1M	2×n · — · —	Open Market also stocks Cocoa
Sugar	\$1M	2×n · — · —	Open Market also stocks Sugar
Basic Milk	\$3M	1×n · — · —	—
Matcha	\$12M	1×n · — · —	Mostly Stage 1 recipes
Junior Researcher	\$4M	1×n · — · —	+1 ResP
Junior Journalist	\$4M	1×n · — · —	+2 Rep
Extra Ingredient Slot	\$5M	1×n · 1×n · 1×n	Face \$5/\$10/\$15M in Stages 1–3
Premium Cocoa	\$8M	— · 1×n · —	Counts as Cocoa, +\$1M to that factory
Premium Sugar	\$8M	— · 1×n · —	Counts as Sugar, +\$1M to that factory
Coffee	\$16M	— · 1×n · —	—
Senior Researcher	\$10M	— · 1×n · —	+2 ResP
Almond	\$12M	— · 1×n · —	—
Senior Journalist	\$10M	— · 1×n · —	+3 Rep
Caramel	\$30M	— · 1×n · 1×n	Enters in Stage 2
Premium Milk	\$14M	— · 1×n · —	Counts as Milk, +\$1M to that factory
Master Researcher	\$24M	— · — · 1×n	+3 ResP
Wild Berries	\$30M	— · — · 1×n	—
Premium Coffee	\$32M	— · — · 1×n	Counts as Coffee, +\$2M to that factory
Premium Almond	\$24M	— · — · 1×n	Counts as Almond, +\$2M to that factory
Master Journalist	\$24M	— · — · 1×n	+4 Rep

Royal Honey	\$60M	— · — · 1×n	—
Sea Salt	\$24M	— · — · 1×n	Recipes using it need Research L2

Chocolatier v2.2.1 — digital playtest available. Full scheme texts match this booklet.